

2022 regulations encompass over 100 types of equipment categorised under seven groups listed in Schedule I, referred to as “Covered Items”. The newly incorporated equipment includes tablets, GPS devices, modems, electronic storage units, solar photovoltaic panels/cells/modules, air purifiers, leisure and sports apparatus, medical devices, laboratory instruments, and many more, covering an entire spectrum of digital devices.

A welcome addition is the updated responsibilities for manufacturers of solar photovoltaic modules, panels, or cells, acknowledging the growing demand for solar panels. “While the shift towards clean and renewable energy through solar power is highly desirable, it is crucial to have an effective mechanism in place for responsibly managing the resulting waste from solar panels,” explains Radhika Kalia, MD at RLG Systems India, a part of the Germany-headquartered Reverse Logistics Group.

With the implementation of such mechanisms, responsible e-waste management is expected to be promoted, leading to a reduction in practices that are detrimental to both health and the environment. Yet, while it’s a good move, there is scope for improvement, says Nitin Gupta, Founder & CEO of Attero Recycling. According to Gupta, the coverage under Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) comprises over 500 products internationally, whereas in India it is merely 100 products.

PARTICIPATION AND COMPLIANCE

Expanding coverage to a wider range of devices is just one part of the new policy. The government is putting the onus on electronics manufacturers by ensuring they participate and comply in managing their products’ end-of-life stages. To start with, all manufacturers, producers, refurbishers,

BURDEN OF WASTE



India is the third-largest producer of e-waste globally after China and the US



E-waste has increased exponentially from 700,000 tonnes in FY18 to 1.6 million tonnes in FY22



India’s e-waste management landscape is largely dominated by unregulated unorganised players



If substances like lead and mercury aren’t disposed of properly, they can cause health hazards



The consumer durables market may see annualised growth of 10 per cent from 2022 to 2027, which could worsen the e-waste problem if not addressed now

Source BT Research, Industry

NEW RULE BOOK

1

On November 2, 2022, E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2022, were notified, and came into effect on April 1, 2023

2

All manufacturers, producers and recyclers are required to register with the Central Pollution Control Board

3

The number of units of electrical and electronic items falling under the rules’ domain increased to 106 from 21

Source BT Research, Industry

\$143.87

billion

PROJECTED MARKET SIZE OF GLOBAL E-WASTE MANAGEMENT BY 2028, UP FROM \$49.88 BILLION IN 2020, PER STATISTA